

CDN Incident Alert: 0057. TLP: CLEAR			Date
Title	PL	False aid claims amplified to undermine Polish support for refugees	14/04/2025

Summary

- Incident: A TikTok video showed a Ukrainian woman with multiple passports joking about receiving Family 800 Plus benefits. Although later clarified as satire, the clip was used by hostile domestic and foreign actors to spread false claims.
- Narrative: The video fuelled claims that Ukrainian refugees exploit Polish aid and show no gratitude.
- Impact: It went viral, gaining over a million views. Pro-Kremlin channels amplified the story and translated it in multiple languages to broaden its reach.
- DISARM TTPs: Disinformation actors weaponized the video to incite hostility toward refugees and undermine trust in Polish support for refugees.
- Countermeasures: Respond by explaining how Polish Family 800 Plus system actually works and flagging misleading accounts spreading the video.

Incident

On March 26, the TikTok channel posted a [video](#) showing a young Ukrainian woman displaying seven Ukrainian passports and claiming she receives Family 800 Plus from the Polish government for each one. When [contacted](#) by Konkret 24, the woman - Ludmila - said the video was a joke and that the passports belonged to her and her family.

Between March 26th and April 1st, the video went viral on platforms X and Telegram. It was shared by problematic seemingly Polish domestic accounts on X (including [@StapelAndrew](#), [@WolnaRadio](#), [@ekonomat_pl](#)) and the pro-Russian Polish language channels on Telegram (including [@RuskiStatek](#), [@infodefPOLAND](#), [@LatajacyHolender](#), [@zbrodnie_kryminal_afery](#)). Russian and Belarusian pro-government actors also posted the story about this video in Russian language on Telegram (including [@belvestnik](#), [@dillfrash](#), [@denazi_UA](#) and others). The video was also shared on four subdomains of Pravda network: [Balkan](#), [Polish](#), [Serbian](#), and [Spanish](#).

Social media posts sharing the video spread anti-government, anti-Ukrainian, and anti-refugee narratives aimed at fuelling resentment within Polish society. Many of them framed the video in a political context - criticising the current Polish government (or opposition party Law and Justice) for allegedly enabling social welfare abuse by the Ukrainian refugees in Poland.

Narrative

Meta narrative: Poland is offering significant and unnecessary support to Ukrainian refugees, but this support is met with ingratitude.

Sub-narratives: Ukrainian refugees are exploiting the aid systems of EU countries. They are manipulating benefits and unfairly profiting at the expense of host governments.

Impact -

Reach: (as of April 7, 2025)

X (formerly Twitter): over 780,000 views, more than 2,800 reposts.

Telegram: over 155,000 views.

YouTube: over 135,000 views.

Websites: Pravda Network published the story on four subdomains.

Languages: video was shared in 10 languages.

Key Objectives and Behaviours ([DISARM Red Framework](#))

Objective: [T0140.003: Spread Hate](#) – the social media post was used to spread hate speech directed at Ukrainian refugees living in Poland and to spin anti-Ukrainian sentiment in general

Objective: [T0135.001: Smear](#) – social media posts sharing the video criticized the Polish government for supposedly allowing such practices and not helping Poles enough.

[T0023.001: Reframe Context](#) – the original video was created to make fun of an online hater (as explained by the creator in other posts, the video also had a sticker that it was in response to a specific comment), but the campaign presented it as a real video depicting a welfare benefit scam.

[T0049.001: Trolls Amplify and Manipulate](#) – the video has been shared and amplified by accounts that are known for spreading problematic narratives.

[T0085.008: Machine Translated Text](#) – the video was spread to an international audience using automated translation. Artifacts of bad translation from Russian were found in some Polish-language posts, showing that the content was later reinjected to the Polish infosphere in efforts of foreign actors to further amplify the video. The video has also been posted on the several language versions of the Pravda Network using machine translation.

[T0115.003: One-Way Direct Posting](#) – the video was shared on a wide range of Telegram channels known for spreading disinformation. Some of the Russian Telegram channels are officially state-affiliated, while others are part of the infrastructure sourced by the Pravda Network (dubbed Portal Kombat by VIGINUM).

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Counter narrative: provide factual information on how Family 800 Plus works;

Name and shame: expose suspicious accounts, which amplify the video with misleading captions;

Report	Threat Actor	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
N/A	Russia	Upon request	Givi Gigitashvili, DFRLab Jakub Kubś, GLOBSEC	X, Telegram, YouTube, Website	